The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Loredas, the 24th of Frostfall (Saturday, October 24, 2026) ·
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Gandy lounges contentedly on the deck while Maevy chases a butterfly under a partly cloudy sky.

Skies o'er the Hold

61° / 46°

Partly cloudy

Sunrise 6:38 AM · Sunset 5:40 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 62/43

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday Waxing Gibbous · *Tonight* Full Moon · *Tomorrow*

waxing toward the full moon

24th of Frostfall = October 24

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
55°	60°	56°	48°
Mostly sunny	Mostly sunny	Partly cloudy	Clear
2 mph	10 mph	9 mph	4 mph

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Monster Mash Tonight, and Art and Airplanes Across the Holds

Payson, Ariz.

Well met, wayfarer, and good Loredas morning — the pines stand tall under a partly cloudy sky, the day warms to 61, and the Holds are dressed for a festival Saturday, by the Nine. Payson dances into its Monster Mash tonight, Sedona closes a week of outdoor painting with a final art sale, Prescott opens its airport for a centennial Air-Fest, and Camp Verde walks and camps on through the weekend. Take a light cloak for the evening, traveler — the mead hall can wait, the road is merry today.



Costumed dancers and carved pumpkins at the Monster Mash — a Loredas night in Payson.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — **Monster Mash**, 4:00 to 9:30 p.m. in Payson. Payson's big family Halloween evening starts earlier this year so families have more room to come and go across the night, with costumes, crowds, and a fall evening outdoors. Bring chairs and blankets for the outdoor Halloween movie, The Nightmare Before Christmas, and enjoy the fun as Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for Rim Country air. Expect a long, festive evening rather than a quick trick-or-treat stop, so check Adventure Payson for the venue details before you go.

  — **Payson Public Library 2026 Book Sale — final day**, 9:00 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. at Payson Public Library, 328 N. McLane Road, Payson, closing a sale that ran October 22–24. Tables of donated books, puzzles, and media wait for new homes, priced for browsing rather than bidding, and the Friends of the Library turn the proceeds back into library good works. Today is the last chance, so come with a tote bag and leave with winter reading. It is an easy, unhurried stop for guests who like a rummage with a purpose.

  — **Truckload Meat Sale at Tractor Supply**, 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. in the parking lot at Tractor Supply, 510 SR-260, Payson, on its second and final day. The tent advertises 20 ribeyes for $50, family packs of beef, chicken, seafood, and pork, and discounts for first responders, military, and seniors on most packs, with cash, cards, and EBT accepted. It is a stock-the-freezer stop, not a festival — go early in the day for the widest pick. Ask at the tent about the day's specials before you buy.

- **Camp Verde**

  — **Breast Cancer Awareness Walk**, 7:00 to 9:00 a.m. at Middle Verde Heritage Park in Camp Verde, with a second walk site at the Clarkdale Learning Center. The Yavapai-Apache Nation's CHR/WIC and Diabetes Program invites YAN community members to walk together this morning, with giveaways for participants. It is an early, good-hearted start to the day, made for community members rather than drop-in visitors. Questions go to the program contacts named on the Nation's page.

  — **Camp Carpe Diem Verde Valley 2026**, running October 22–25 at Verde River RV Resort & Cottages, 1472 West Horseshoe Bend Drive, Camp Verde. This hosted RV-and-camping weekend uses Camp Verde as its base for exploring the whole Verde Valley, with hiking, biking, breweries, wineries, and ghost towns by day and campfire gatherings by night. It is a social, ticketed gathering rather than a drop-in town fair, so guests already in the valley with an RV will get the most from it. Expect a ready-made company of fellow travelers and a planned menu of outings.

- **Sedona**

  — **Fall Arts & Crafts Fair**, 9:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum, 735 Jordan Road, Sedona. The museum's annual fall fair is timed for early holiday shopping, with handmade jewelry, ceramics, fine art, home décor, cards, woodcarvings, glass, candles, and lotions from local and regional makers, and lunch available for purchase. Many of these artisans do only this show or a handful of others, so the goods are genuinely hard to find elsewhere. The museum grounds in Jordan Historical Park make it a pleasant browse, not a mall run.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Finale and Final Art Sale**, 9:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Road, Sedona, with free admission per the festival guide. After a week of artists painting the red rocks outdoors, the festival closes with a community paint-out in the morning, judging at noon, and the final art sale from 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. There is even pumpkin painting by the festival artists from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. It is the last chance to meet the painters and buy the week's work before they leave town.

- **Prescott**

  — **Prescott Centennial AirFest**, 11:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. at Prescott Regional Airport — Ernest A. Love Field, 6110 Wilkinson Drive, Prescott, and free per the City page. The airport celebrates its centennial with aircraft and military displays, food trucks, and a Touch-a-Truck with Prescott Fire and Copperstate Ambulance so kids can climb on real equipment. It is an open-air, wander-at-your-own-pace day rather than a seated airshow. A good all-ages outing, and an easy drive for guests already headed to Prescott.

— **Costumes for Kids 5K & Halloween Fest**, starting 9:00 a.m. in Prescott, per the Prescott Places weekend picks. Runners and walkers take the course in costume for a Halloween-morning fundraiser feel — part race, part costume parade, and friendly to families. Expect a merry crowd in the cool morning air rather than a serious race-day scrum. Check the weekend listing for the start place and sign-up details before you go.

The Days Ahead

- **Sun, Oct. 25**

  — **Prescott — Prescott Community Gardens Fall Festival**, 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. at the Prescott Community Gardens, per the Prescott events calendar; the listing did not print the street address, so check it before you go. The gardeners open the gates for a fall celebration among the beds — a harvest-season gathering with the year's growing behind it and winter planting ahead. Expect neighbors, garden talk, and a last wander through green things before the frosts settle in. A gentle Sundas outing for guests who garden, or wish they did.

  — **Sedona — Haunted History**, 3:00 to 4:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum, 735 Jordan Road, Sedona, with tickets at $10 per the museum calendar. An hour of Sedona's spookier local history, told at the museum in Jordan Historical Park — ghost-season storytelling with real town stories behind it. It is a seated, small-room kind of outing, good for guests who like their Halloween with a history lesson. Arrive a little early, for museum programs fill their chairs fast.

  — **Payson — Spiritual Soup**, 11:15 a.m. to 12:15 p.m. at 904 N. Beeline Highway, Suite E, Payson, and on Zoom. This monthly discussion group takes up a spiritual topic together — this meeting's topic is Forgiving Yourself and Others — with a facilitator and a love-offering basis. It meets on the second and fourth Sundays, so this is the month's second gathering. A quiet, thoughtful hour for guests who like conversation over coffee-table topics.

- **Mon, Oct. 26**

  — **Pine-Strawberry — Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose**, 4:00 to 7:00 p.m. at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 AZ-87, Pine. Local players, singers, poets, and storytellers take turns rather than one headline act, hosted by members of the Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction team, with tips benefiting Fuel Reduction's work. Open mics in the twin villages are community living rooms — expect neighbors, a few surprises, and music made for love of it. It is good for guests who want an evening that feels like the town, not a show put on for tourists.

  — **Sedona — Verde Valley Fiber Artisans**, 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum, 735 Jordan Road, Sedona, per the museum calendar. Fiber artists gather to work, talk shop, and share projects in the museum's setting — weaving, spinning, and stitching among people who love the crafts. Visitors who sew, knit, or weave will find kindred spirits and plenty to look at. Check the museum calendar before you go for the room and any supply notes.

- **Tue, Oct. 27**

  — **Pine-Strawberry — Trail Day Volunteer Build**, 7:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m. on the trail project off Highway 87, just before Pine. Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to help clear brush, move rocks, and shape a trail that will also give firefighters better access when the community needs it. Tools are provided, no experience is needed, and volunteers bring water, sunscreen, gloves if they have them, and sturdy shoes. To volunteer, email trails@psfuelreduction.org and the directions and details come back by return mail.

- **Thu, Oct. 29**

  — **Pine-Strawberry — Haunted Barn at the Pine Community Center**, 5:00 to 10:00 p.m. at the Pine Community Center grounds, 3886 AZ-87, Pine. The twin villages raise their haunted barn for Halloween week — a walk-through fright made by locals, in a real barn, under the Rim. It is the Holdings' own harvest-of-scares, merry and spooky in equal measure, and a fine excuse for an evening drive up the 87. Check the event page for tickets and age guidance before you go, and mind the mountain road home.

— **Sedona — Fiddler on the Rock**, 5:15 to 6:45 p.m., listed on the Sedona Heritage Museum calendar; the listing did not name the exact room, so check it before you go. A fiddler plays among the red rocks in the late light — a small, musical evening rather than a big concert-hall night. It pairs well with a slow Uptown supper afterwards. Guests who love a tune with their sunset will be glad they went.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torches, and the doors — the Hearth's workshop quests await.

- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue — was due Oct. 17. Finalize the size, cut and engrave the layered plywood, mount the 3D-printed troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24. Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, placed for best sight from the walkway.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue — was due Oct. 10. Paint, seal for sun, wire the sockets with the breaker off, mount both torches, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Oct. 3. Print two torches plus the socket test piece and test-fit the bulb and socket.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Sept. 26. Measure the bulb and socket, scale the sconce model, check the door-light wiring, and slice in PETG.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24. The front and side door work for the guest house.

Due today, Saturday, Oct. 24: mount the shield by the front door, and the doors quest comes due the same day — the workshop will be busy, by the Nine!

Merchant of the Hold

Old County Inn · *Pine*



Old County Inn in Pine — wood-fired pies and a meadow under the pines.

In a stoplight-free mountain town under the Rim, Old County Inn fires up its wood oven every day it is open for scratch-made wood-fired pizzas, with the sausage, bacon, pickles, and cocktail syrups all made in house. By the Nine, a pizza oven that good would need a little magic in Skyrim, so picture a neat heat enchantment roaring behind the counter while the famous Meat Pie and the creamy Burrata pizza come out generous and hot. The signature thing to try is the Burrata pizza — and the Green Chile Beer Cheese with breadsticks while you wait.

> *"This little Pine, Arizona Inn truly has some of the best and most creative woodfired pizzas we've had anywhere."* — TripAdvisor review

3502 N. Highway 87, Pine, AZ 85544. Hours: Wednesday–Sunday 11:00 a.m.–9:00 p.m., closed Mondays and Tuesdays. Phone: (928) 476-6560. Price range: moderate ($$). Good to know: dog-friendly with plenty of outdoor seating, live music most weekends, reservations only for parties over ten, and the occasional elk has been spotted from the patio. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Because it is Rim Country's own scratch-made pizza hall — wood-fired pies, Arizona craft beer, and a meadow under the pines, twenty minutes up the road in Pine. Great praise is great, and this little inn has earned every word!

Tales from the Treeline

The Great Monster Mash Costume Fitting



Earl's Monster Mash fitting — boughs, pumpkin, and one approving cluck.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) woke under a partly cloudy Loredas sky with a grand notion: Earl (an elk) should go to tonight's Monster Mash in costume, and Jethro would fit him himself. Out came pine boughs, a coil of twine, and a hollow pumpkin saved for just such an emergency.

Earl stood very still and very dignified while Jethro tied boughs along his back like a forest come to life. The pumpkin hat, though, would not sit straight between those enormous antlers — left, right, left again, until it settled at a jaunty angle that Jethro declared 'terrifying, probably.' Henny (the Hearth's chicken) walked one slow circle as judge, pecked the twine once, and gave a single approving cluck.

Then a butterfly crossed the clearing, Earl turned his head to watch it, and the whole costume turned with him — boughs, pumpkin, and all — like a small woodland revolving door. Jethro clapped anyway. If you see a pine forest dancing at the Mash tonight, traveler, that is not a forest. That is Earl, and he would like you to know he is a monster now.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Loredas be free of wolves, the admin.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com